structure Asian trade and economic relations in ways most beneficial to their own interests. There will undoubtedly be periods of greater political cooperation between Beijing and Tokyo, such as that trumpeted by Xi and Abe in the fall of 2018, along with the minimal quotidian diplomatic niceties.[30] There will continue to be grassroots exchange—at the very least, unorganized exchange through millions of tourists.

Their histories and civilizational achievements, however, all but ensure that they will remain the two most powerful Asian nations, and that implies an ongoing competition. Whether Japan remains allied to the United States or not, or whether China successfully forges a pan-Asian Belt and Road community, the two will continue to try to shape the Asian political, economic, and security environment. With a United States that continues to be challenged by its global commitments and interests, thereby leading to periods of relative lassitude in Asia, China and Japan will stay bound in a complex, often tense, and competitive relationship that is Asia's eternal great game.

Notes

1. World Bank, International Comparison Program Database, "GDP, PPP (current international $), China," https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/NY.GDP.MKTP.PP.CD?locations=CN&year_high_desc=true (accessed July 26, 2019).
2. See 2018 World Bank statistics at https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/NY.GDP.PCAP.CD?locations=JP-CN (accessed July 26, 2019).
3. *The 12th Japan-China Joint Opinion Poll Analysis Report on the Comparative Data* (Tokyo: Genron NPO, 2016), 3, http://www.genron-npo.net/pdf/2016forum_en.pdf.
4. Bruce Stokes, "Hostile Neighbors: China vs. Japan," Pew Research Center, September 13, 2016, http://www.pewglobal.org/2016/09/13/hostile-neighbors-china-vs-japan.
5. Philip J. Cunningham, "China's TV War Machine," *New York Times*, September 11, 2014, https://www.nytimes.com/2014/09/12/opinion/chinas-tv-war-on-japan.html.